

“

***Apna hi
toh hai.***

***Thoda kam
kar do.”***

The **most expensive sentence** you can hear
as a business owner.

I've watched people spend...



Lakhs on a wedding stage

they'll see for six hours

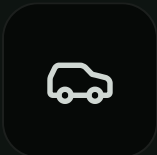
6 HOURS



Absurd money on a phone

because the logo is visible from across the room

THE LOGO



₹3 lakh on a car accessory

that nobody actually needed

NOBODY NEEDED



Then you quote ₹60K for a system

that could make their business money for years.

“Yaar, itna kya hai ismein?”

AND SUDDENLY

Because apparently, if you can...

 photograph it

 show it to people

 park it outside your house

 talk about it at a wedding

...it's worth paying for.



But if someone is sitting behind a laptop building **the thing that actually runs your business...**

“Apna hai na.”

And Kashmir makes it even more interesting.

 IF THEY DON'T KNOW YOU

“Kitna charge karte ho?”

How much do you charge?

 IF THEY KNOW YOU

“Kitne mein apna karoge?”

How much for “one of us”?

Same work	=	Same work
Same hours	=	Same hours
Same expertise	=	Same expertise
Stranger	≠	Relationship

Just a different relationship.

Then comes the classic:

*“Bas apne liye kar do.
Baad mein aur kaam denge.”*

The future work

⌚ SOMEHOW NEVER ARRIVES

?

Promised today...someday

The discount

⚡ ARRIVES IMMEDIATELY

✓

Asked todayApplied today

I don't mind people negotiating. But it gets weird when **your relationship becomes the discount.**



You don't get cheaper **electricity** because you know the owner.



You don't get cheaper **fuel** because you're friends with the pump guy.



You don't negotiate with **Apple** because you went to school with Tim Cook.

So why does knowing me suddenly make my work **worth less?**

Maybe that's the part **we need to unlearn.**

apna *(adj.) · Hindi / Urdu*

“one of our own”



SHOULD MEAN

You trust the person.



NOT

~~**You get their work at cost.**~~

We learned this the hard way. The best clients aren't always the ones with **the biggest budgets.**

The hours	what you see
Everything it took	what you're paying for
Years of learning the craft	
Projects that taught us what not to do	
The tools, systems & experience	
Becoming capable of doing it	

They're the ones who understand that when they pay for something, **they're not paying for the hours.**

They're paying for **everything it took to become capable of doing it.**

And that has a price. Even when the person doing it is someone you know.